

How to use these token cutouts



These pages contain the text *The Tale of Peter Rabbit* by Beatrix Potter. Each **cutout** shows a **next word** paired with the **previous word** that came immediately before it in the original text.

Model vitals	
1123 tokens	2.25 bits/token entropy
4.8 perplexity	2.32 branching factor

Anatomy of a cutout



Every distinct word has its own colour. **Previous** words appear inside a coloured box (the word's own colour as the background, with white text); the free-standing **next word** appears in plain coloured text. The same word always wears the same colour, whether you see it inside a box or free-standing. Two unrelated words can occasionally share a colour, so always verify the word itself matches—not just the colour.

Setup

Cut out the tokens along the dotted lines and **spread them out** face-up on the table, with no overlap if possible. This is the “training” step: every (previous, next) combination from the original text is now a physical cutout sitting on your table.

How to play: the matching game

To generate text, repeatedly find a cutout whose **previous word** matches the last word you've written, then **write its next word** onto your page. The word you just wrote becomes part of what you'll match against next—that's the chain.

Worked example

Step 1. Pick any cutout to begin—say this one—and copy its previous word *and* its next word onto your page.

Step 2. Look at the last word you’ve written (*upon*) and find a cutout whose previous word matches it. Write its next word.

Step 3. Repeat: find a cutout whose previous word matches the last word you’ve written, and add its next word.

Keep going—write as much or as little as you like.

the cutout

Once upon

upon a

a time

your page

Once upon

Once upon a

Once upon a **time**

Tips

Use colour as a fast filter. Scan by the rightmost previous-word box’s colour first, then verify the actual word matches.

Pick from many candidates by eye. The more cutouts share the same previous word, the more often your eye lands on one—that’s **weighted sampling** for free, and it’s why some words follow others more often in your text.

Put the cutout back after using it—removing it would change the model’s distribution next time round.

Once **Once** upon **upon** a **a** time **time** there
there **were** **were** four **four** little **little** Rabbits
Rabbits , **,** and **and** their **their** names
names **were** **were** Flopsy **Flopsy** , **,** Mopsy
Mopsy , **,** Cotton **Cotton** tail **tail** , **,** and
and Peter **Peter** . **.** They **They** lived **lived** with
with their **their** mother **mother** in **in** a **a** sand
sand bank **bank** , **,** underneath **underneath** the
the root **root** of **of** a **a** very **very** big **big** fir
fir tree **tree** . **.** now **now** my **my** dears **dears** ,

, said said old old Mrs Mrs . . rabbit

rabbit one one morning morning , , you

you may may go go into into the the fields

fields or or down down the the lane lane ,

, but but don't don't go go into into Mr Mr .

. McGregor's McGregor's garden garden : : your

your Father Father had had an an accident

accident there there ; ; he he was was put

put in in a a pie pie by by Mrs Mrs .

. McGregor McGregor . . now now run

run along along , , and and don't don't get

get into into mischief mischief . . I I am

am going going out out . . then then old

old Mrs Mrs . . rabbit rabbit took took a

a basket basket and and her her umbrella

umbrella , , and and went went through

through the the wood wood to to the

the baker's baker's . . she she bought bought a

a loaf loaf of of brown brown bread bread and

and five five currant currant buns buns .

. Flopsy Flopsy , Mopsy Mopsy , and
and Cottontail Cottontail , who who were
were good good little little bunnies bunnies ,
, went went down down the the lane lane to
to gather gather blackberries blackberries :
: but but Peter Peter , who who was
was very very naughty naughty , , ran
ran straight straight away away to to Mr Mr .
. McGregor's McGregor's garden garden , , and
and squeezed squeezed under under the

the gate gate ! ! first first he he ate ate some
some lettuces lettuces and and some
some French French beans beans ; ; and
and then then he he ate ate some
some radishes radishes ; ; and and then then ,
, feeling feeling rather rather sick sick , , he
he went went to to look look for for some
some parsley parsley . . but but round
round the the end end of of a a cucumber
cucumber frame frame , , whom whom should

should he he meet meet but but Mr Mr .

. McGregor McGregor ! ! Mr Mr . . McGregor

McGregor was was on on his his hands

hands and and knees knees planting

planting out out young young cabbages

cabbages , , but but he he jumped jumped up

up and and ran ran after after Peter Peter ,

, waving waving a a rake rake and and calling

calling out out , , Stop Stop thief thief !

! Peter Peter was was most most dreadfully

dreadfully frightened frightened ; ; he

he rushed rushed all all over over the

the garden garden , , for for he he had

had forgotten forgotten the the way way back

back to to the the gate gate . . he he lost

lost one one of of his his shoes shoes among

among the the cabbages cabbages , , and

and the the other other shoe shoe amongst

amongst the the potatoes potatoes . . after

after losing losing them them , , he he ran

ran on on four four legs legs and and went

went faster faster , , so so that that I I think

think he he might might have have got

got away away altogether altogether if if he

he had had not not unfortunately

unfortunately run run into into a a gooseberry

gooseberry net net , , and and got got caught

caught by by the the large large buttons

buttons on on his his jacket jacket . . it

it was was a a blue blue jacket jacket with

with brass brass buttons buttons , , quite
quite new new . . Peter Peter gave
gave himself himself up up for for lost lost ,
, and and shed shed big big tears tears ; ; but
but his his sobs sobs were were overheard
overheard by by some some friendly
friendly sparrows sparrows , , who who flew
flew to to him him in in great
great excitement excitement , , and
and implored implored him him to to exert

exert himself himself . Mr Mr . McGregor

McGregor came came up up with with a

a sieve sieve , , which which he he intended

intended to to pop pop upon upon the the top

top of of Peter Peter ; ; but but Peter

Peter wriggled wriggled out out just just in

in time time , , leaving leaving his his jacket

jacket behind behind him him . . and

and rushed rushed into into the the tool

tool shed shed , , and and jumped

jumped into into a a can can . . it it would

would have have been been a a beautiful

beautiful thing thing to to hide hide in in ,

, if if it it had had not not had had so

so much much water water in in it it . . Mr

Mr . . McGregor McGregor was was quite

quite sure sure that that Peter Peter was

was somewhere somewhere in in the the tool

tool shed shed , , perhaps perhaps hidden

hidden underneath underneath a a flower

flower pot pot . he he began began to
to turn turn them them over over carefully
carefully , , looking looking under under each
each . . presently presently Peter Peter sneezed
sneezed Kertyschoo Kertyschoo ! ! Mr Mr .
. McGregor McGregor was was after after him
him in in no no time time . . and and tried
tried to to put put his his foot foot upon
upon Peter Peter , , who who jumped
jumped out out of of a a window window ,

, upsetting upsetting three three plants plants .

. the the window window was was too

too small small for for Mr Mr . . McGregor

McGregor , , and and he he was was tired

tired of of running running after after Peter

Peter . . he he went went back back to to his

his work work . . Peter Peter sat sat down

down to to rest rest ; ; he he was was out

out of of breath breath and and trembling

trembling with with fright fright , , and

and he he had had not not the the least

least idea idea which which way way to to go

go . . Also Also he he was was very

very damp damp with with sitting sitting in

in that that can can . . after after a a time

time he he began began to to wander

wander about about , , going going lippity

lippity lippity lippity not not very very fast

fast , , and and looking looking all all round

round . . he he found found a a door door in

in a a wall wall ; ; but but it it was
was locked locked , , and and there there was
was no no room room for for a a fat fat little
little rabbit rabbit to to squeeze
squeeze underneath underneath . . an an old
old mouse mouse was was running running in
in and and out out over over the the stone
stone doorstep doorstep , , carrying
carrying peas peas and and beans beans to
to her her family family in in the the wood

wood . Peter Peter asked asked her her the
the way way to to the the gate gate , , but
but she she had had such such a a large
large pea pea in in her her mouth mouth that
that she she could could not not answer
answer . she she only only shook shook her
her head head at at him him . Peter
Peter began began to to cry cry . then
then he he tried tried to to find find his
his way way straight straight across across the

the garden garden , , but but he he became

became more more and and more

more puzzled puzzled . . presently presently ,

, he he came came to to a a pond pond where

where Mr Mr . . McGregor McGregor filled

filled his his water water cans cans . . a

a white white cat cat was was staring

staring at at some some gold gold fish fish ,

, she she sat sat very very , , very very still

still , , but but now now and and then

then the the tip tip of of her her tail

tail twitched twitched as as if if it it were

were alive alive . . Peter Peter thought

thought it it best best to to go go away

away without without speaking speaking to

to her her ; ; he he had had heard

heard about about cats cats from from his

his cousin cousin , , little little Benjamin

Benjamin Bunny Bunny . . he he went

went back back towards towards the the tool

tool shed shed , but but suddenly suddenly ,
 , quite quite close close to to him him , he
he heard heard the the noise noise of of a
a hoe hoe scr scr r ritch ritch , scratch
scratch , scratch scratch , scratch scratch .
. Peter Peter scuttered scuttered underneath
underneath the the bushes bushes . but
but presently presently , as as nothing
nothing happened happened , he he came
came out out , and and climbed

climbed upon upon a a wheelbarrow
wheelbarrow and and peeped peeped over
over . the the first first thing thing he
he saw saw was was Mr Mr . . McGregor
McGregor hoeing hoeing onions onions . . his
his back back was was turned turned towards
towards Peter Peter , , and and beyond
beyond him him was was the the gate gate !
! Peter Peter got got down down very
very quietly quietly off off the the wheelbarrow

wheelbarrow ; ; and and started

started running running as as fast fast as

as he he could could go go , , along along a

a straight straight walk walk behind

behind some some black black currant

currant bushes bushes . . Mr Mr . . McGregor

McGregor caught caught sight sight of of him

him at at the the corner corner , , but

but Peter Peter did did not not care care .

. he he slipped slipped underneath

underneath the the gate gate , , and and was
was safe safe at at last last in in the the wood
wood outside outside the the garden garden .
. Mr Mr . . McGregor McGregor hung hung up
up the the little little jacket jacket and
and the the shoes shoes for for a a scare
scare crow crow to to frighten frighten the
the blackbirds blackbirds . . Peter Peter never
never stopped stopped running running or
or looked looked behind behind him him till

till he he got got home home to to the
the big big fir fir tree tree . he he was
was so so tired tired that that he he flopped
flopped down down upon upon the the nice
nice soft soft sand sand on on the the floor
floor of of the the rabbit rabbit hole hole and
and shut shut his his eyes eyes . his
his mother mother was was busy busy cooking
cooking ; she she wondered wondered what
what he he had had done done with with his

his clothes clothes . it it was was the
the second second little little jacket jacket and
and pair pair of of shoes shoes that that Peter
Peter had had lost lost in in a a fortnight
fortnight ! ! I I am am sorry sorry to to say
say that that Peter Peter was was not not very
very well well during during the the evening
evening . . his his mother mother put put him
him to to bed bed , , and and made
made some some camomile camomile tea tea ;

; and and she she gave gave a a dose dose of
of it it to to Peter Peter ! ! one one table
table spoonful spoonful to to be be taken
taken at at bed bed time time . . but
but Flopsy Flopsy , , Mopsy Mopsy , , and
and Cotton Cotton tail tail had had bread
bread and and milk milk and and blackberries
blackberries for for supper supper .